

DYLAN BUCHANAN

GRADUATE GAMES DEVELOPER | TUTOR

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PROFESSIONAL OVERVIEW

Graduate game developer and Course Lead with a strong focus on Unreal Engine using both C++ and Blueprints. Experienced in designing and implementing enjoyable gameplay mechanics while balancing technical functionality with player experience. My background in tutoring has strengthened my communication, problem-solving, and collaboration skills. Passionate about creating engaging player experiences, I am eager to contribute my technical expertise and creativity within a professional game development team.

WORK EXPERIENCE (SOFTWARE)

Course Lead – 3D Games Design & Development

Software Academy, Remote | 11/2024 - Present

- Delivered NCFE-accredited Unreal Engine courses to 100+ students aged 8-16.
- Promoted to Course Lead within 9 months, taking ownership of curriculum development, as well as tutor QA and support.
- Provided technical support to students, tutors, and general staff.
- Designed and developed 6 Unreal Engine projects (under NDA) using Blueprints, focusing on gameplay systems, intuitive UI design, and level creation in line with NCFE guidelines.
- Produced comprehensive written documentation, guides, and educational resources for both students and staff.
- Created and recorded video tutorials to support course delivery and independent student learning.
- Managed multiple content development projects simultaneously, consistently meeting production and delivery deadlines.
- Collaborated with a team of Course Leads to develop, review, and maintain course content and teaching standards.

Unreal Engine Developer (Community Project)

AliCodeMakers (Instagram), Remote | 05/2026 - Present

- Hand-selected as a team of 3 to contribute to a community-led Unreal Engine game (top comment picks the next mechanic).
- Work within same-day deadlines to plan, record, and develop engaging, appropriate, and modular systems.
- Utilise source control to collaborate with the other developers.

EXAMPLE PROJECTS

Word Race (Mobile) | Unreal Engine 5 | C++/Blueprint | Solo

- Developed an Android word game using data-driven gameplay and custom UI.
- Shortlisted for Top 5 Game Prototypes - GradEx 2025 (Staffordshire University).

Floor 54 (PC) | Unreal Engine 5 | C++/Blueprint | Team of 25

- Served as Lead Programmer developing level progression, interaction, and custom UI systems.
- Coordinated development and GitHub integration over a 9-week period.

EDUCATION

BSc (Hons) Game Development

Staffordshire University - 2025
First Class

HNC – Creative Media Design

South Staffs College - 2023
Distinction*

PROFICIENCIES

Languages (most to least proficient)

- C++
- C#
- Python

Game Engines (most to least proficient)

- Unreal Engine
- Unity

Web Development Stack

- NextJS
- HTML/CSS
- JavaScript/TypeScript

Other Tools (most to least proficient)

- Git
- Microsoft & Google Suites
- Trello/Jira

PORTFOLIO

